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DEPARTMENT OF MEDIA STUDIES

**JDM111-2 FUNDAMENTALS OF REPORTING
PORTFOLIO SUBMISSION**

SUBMITTED BY- SWASTIKA

2 BAJE

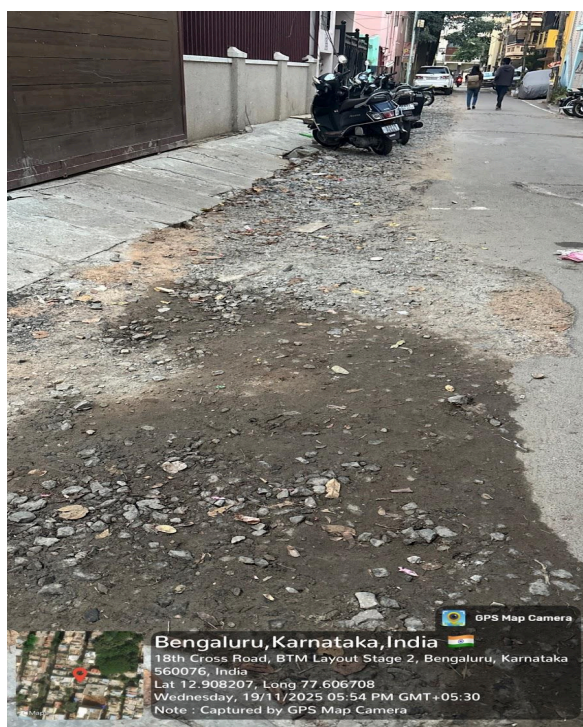
2530168

**Under the guidance of Prof. Joel M Jacob
and Prof Tinam Borah**

Damaged Roads, Power Cuts and Poor Internet Disrupt Daily Life in BTM Layout Stage-2 By- Swastika, 2530168

Residents of the BTM layout stage 2 say damaged roads, frequent power cuts and unstable internet is disrupting daily lives. "The conditions of the roads here are just getting worse and nobody is doing anything about it." Says Prajwal, a resident of the 18th cross road, BTM Layout stage-2, Bangalore. Prajwal, a software engineer, has been living in this neighbourhood for about three years. When questioned about the problems he faces in that area, he replied that the roads in the neighbourhood are already very narrow and the poor condition makes commuting even more difficult, especially in the monsoon season. According to him the roads were dug up due to issues with the pipeline and sewage lines. The authorities did the road cutting in order to work on the pipelines but never repaired them back. "The Bangalore weather is very inconsistent and we face a lot of challenges because the vehicles get stuck in some damaged areas of the roads," Prajwal explains. He also states that it is not just the roads but the residents of the 18th cross also face a lot of issues with the electricity. There are consistent power cuts, especially on the weekends, where the residents have to survive without any electricity for about two to three hours. "As you can see there is a lot of wiring here in this area, so if a huge vehicle collides with these wires we don't get internet access as well." Prajwal works in a hybrid environment as a software engineer, and it is really challenging for him to work from home without a stable internet access. When asked if he has lodged any formal complaint or talk to anybody about the issues he is facing, Prajwal states that "Not yet, we complain to our owners and they discuss with the authorities, but nobody really does anything about it." According to him, the authorities usually respond by saying that they are doing whatever they can. Akshay, another resident of the same neighbourhood, states that the roads have been in this condition for about three months now. "There is a lot of dust, and during the rainy season the roads are all muddy. Akshay, who owns a dog named Ghost, says it has become difficult to take him for walks because of the damaged roads. Ashay also shares a similar experience regarding formal complaints. "We complain to our owners, when they talk to the authorities, they promise to fix it in two to three months, but the conditions are the same," he explains. When questioned about the problems faced by the citizens, Vaikant Swami, an official member of the local MLA's team replied "almost all the roads are like that in Bangalore city." When asked how he and his team plan to make the conditions any better, Swami replied by saying "It is very easy for people to blame, we are doing whatever we can." He also mentioned how there are not enough funds allocated to repair these damaged roads and streets. When this issue was raised in front of Naresh, a local civic volunteer we talked to, he replied by saying that is a very common example of poor coordination between civic agencies. "Digging up the roads only shows that the city lacks a unified system to manage utilities." For now the residents are left to navigate the same broken roads, power cuts and unstable internet. They can only hope for improvement. Reflective essay

As a journalism student I learnt how urban neglect shapes people's lives. What began as a normal assignment soon turned into a harsh reality of civic failure. While interviewing Prajwal, a software engineer, who has lived there for three years, made me realize how damaged infrastructure disrupts routine life. He explained how the already narrow streets of the 18th cross road were of no use in the monsoon season. The dug up roads make it ten times harder for people to commute easily. The damaged road for pipelines, and never repaired back only means one thing, projects start but the authorities never take accountability and completion. His struggles with constant power cuts and unstable internet only highlight how hard it must be to live in a place with no good access to basic utilities. In an era of hybrid work even a slightest tangle in overhead wiring can affect the productivity and efficiency of a corporate worker. His mention of big vehicles colliding with the wires only points to one thing, fragile urban infrastructure. Speaking to Akshay only confirmed things. The difficulty that he faced in only taking his dog on a walk due to mud, dust and damaged roads showed how civic neglect erodes the quality of everyday lives. The most eye-opening experience of this whole exercise has to be meeting Mr. Vainkat Swami. An official member of the MLS's team, gave very dismissive remarks. He claims, "almost all roads in Bengaluru are like that" revealed a very huge gap between administrative perception and citizen's lived reality. Instead of giving any solutions for the problems faced by the residents, Swami became defensive. This experience taught me that journalism is not only about reporting facts but also amplifying the voices that often go unheard. The news values that were involved in this hard news assignment were: proximity, timeliness and human interest.



Damaged roads in BTM Layout Stage-2 continue to obstruct daily movement for residents.

November 19, 2025

5:54 PM



In front of the MLA's house to speak with Viankat Swami (he refused to take any pictures)

November 24, 2025

Sources with names and numbers

Prajwal (victim) : [REDACTED]

Akshay: [REDACTED]

Vinkat Swami (official): [REDACTED]

Naresh (source expert) : [REDACTED]

Uncollected Garbage Continues to Choke Kashi Nagar

By Swastika , 2BAJE- 2530168

Kashi Nagar, located close to JP Nagar, continues to struggle with severe waste management issues. The residents report that garbage has been piling up for months, creating a very unhygienic environment. Many claim that despite repeated complaints, the area rarely receives the same level of attention that neighbouring localities get. Ashwin, a student living in Kashi Nagar explained the situation as “very unhygienic,” adding that the condition has been unchanged for a long time. When asked whether any authorities had visited the area for cleaning he said “No one comes, it is very dirty.” Residents also complain that the accumulated waste makes it difficult to travel through some parts of the locality due to the strong foul smell. Many fear that the lack of regular waste collection could pose health risks if authorities don't intervene soon. At one of the corners in Kashi Nagar, Baba Thakur Rajput runs a chaat stall. A migrant worker from Jhansi, Uttar Pradesh, Baba helps his brother-in-law with the stall. He states that “I have to cover my nose when passing through these areas.” He stated that the authorities do come, but only rarely. Baba also mentioned how he had to change the location of his stall as the previous place had a foul smell. When asked about his thoughts on the bad waste management conditions in Kashi Nagar, he stated that “Sab phenkne wale hi hain koi uthata nahi hai.” He explained that while everyone throws garbage anywhere and everywhere, nobody bothers to clean it or pick it up and dispose of it in the proper place. He also stated that “It is only we who throw things everywhere, but we never consider picking it and disposing of it.” According to Baba, to bring change in society, one needs to bring change within oneself. One of the families living in the neighbourhood complained how they are worried about their children getting sick because of the amount of open waste. Shuba, a BBMP official when informed about the waste management issues in Kashi Nagar, acknowledged the situation but stressed that the civic body is working on improving the conditions. “We are aware that certain pockets like Kashi Nagar face waste management issues,” said the officer. She stated that the problem majorly arises because of mixed waste, the residents dumping garbage in street corners. The officers assured that steps are being taken in order to improve the situation. “We have already issued instructions to the local waste collection team to increase the frequency of pickups.” However she also placed responsibility on the residents, they stated that people should make sure they are segregating waste before dumping it. Usually cases like waste management take a long time to be resolved, especially in pocket areas like Kashi Nagar. When asked how they can take quick actions with the problems of the residents she replied “The first step is to form a formal complaint, we always look at complaints but just in case the complaints are not being addressed then the residents can come to the offices.” Health experts warn that prolonged exposure to uncollected waste can lead to spread of vector-borne diseases. Environmentalists add that lack of proper waste segregation in areas like Kashi Nagar increases the pressure on Bengaluru's already overburdened landfills, worsening the city's overall waste crisis. Residents now can only hope that with timely intervention from the authorities, these long-standing issues can finally begin to see meaningful change.

Reflective essay

Once while I was travelling from JP Nagar to SG Palaya, I noticed these piles of waste dumped on the side of the roads in Kashi Nagar. It was not only Kashi Nagar that had poor waste management, but a lot more areas with the same civic issue. I felt that the foul smell

from the open waste must be bothering the residents of the area and so I decided to address this civic issue through this assignment. The news values that I identified through this civic issue are proximity. Since Kashi Nagar is close to JP Nagar, the issue is geographically relevant to many readers. Impact is another news value that I identified as this issue affects entire neighbourhoods, local businesses, families with children, and daily commuters. I found out that not a lot of people wanted to talk about waste management, it was hard to find people who were willing to give an interview. Travelling through the BMTC bus was a fun experience. Though it was hard to find which bus to board, as everything was in Kannada. But soon I got the hang of it and the process felt less complicated.



Garbage accumulation in Kashi Nagar continues due to irregular waste collection.



Baba Rajput Thakur in front of his Chaat stall.

Ashwin- [REDACTED]

Baba Rajput Thaku- [REDACTED]

Shuba- [REDACTED]

Dim lights sometimes lead to brighter memories

- ***Sampada V. Pai and Swastika Chahar***

In the busy streets of SG Palya, where most of us are just trying to get to class on time, there lies a small shop in the crowd of shops that surround the area. There is a shop with overflowing utensils.

“Never in my wildest dreams did I think that I’d move out of Rajasthan.” In the bustling streets of SG Palya, Raju runs his utility shop and has become a familiar stop for the locals. Originally from Jodhpur, Rajasthan, Raju moved to Bangalore nearly twenty years ago in search of better living standards. Over the years, the narrow lanes of SG Palya, constantly filled with students, vendors and honking cars, have become his home. Raju stated that after working for a year, he grew fond of the weather and decided to settle in Bangalore. When asked about his educational qualifications, he stated, “I have done my MBA from Rajasthan itself.” Raju, before owning a utilities shop, had served in the Indian Navy but had to leave due to some professional reasons. Raju lives in Bangalore with his wife and son. His son, just like him, completed his BBA from Christ University and is now working for Upgrade, an HR consulting company. Raju also mentioned how it was extremely hard for him to survive in a different city with a language barrier. “I struggled the first year living in Bangalore, but soon I learnt the language.” When asked if he ever considered moving back to his hometown in Rajasthan, Raju said, “I will have to start from scratch to survive in my hometown.” He visits his family in Jodhpur every six months but doesn't plan to move back anytime soon. Raju claims that he had around twenty businesses during his two decades in the city. He experimented with different businesses such as sweets, clothes and jewellery. Still, he decided to stick with the utilities business, as it thrived in a student-populated area like SG Palya. Though he would need to start from scratch, Raju claims that a fast-paced city like Bangalore has no fun left in it. He states that the traffic and the living expenses are slowly changing his perspective, making him reconsider his decision to never leave the city and return to Rajasthan. He states, “A 1BHK flat costs no less than twenty thousand, while a shop costs at least fifty.” He adds that surviving as a business owner in the area has become extremely challenging. Raju also states that the only reason he has been able to sustain himself is because of the fact that he has been in this business for over fifteen years.

These 15 years have not been easy for Raju, being away from home when home is sullen. His family history consists of a lineage of government officers serving the nation. Raju himself served in the air force wing, but left because he knew it wasn't

what he wanted to do, and it's inspiring to see how he shifted from business to business in Bangalore “I was only able to sustain myself here because I knew my game. At the end of the day, for me, it's the love for the game that makes me do business.” Raju loves exploring, and one can tell he said he understands what tactics he must use to survive in a competitive market in Bangalore. Raju explained how doing these business ventures taught him how to make his life more comfortable. “It's not about being the richest in the room; it's about being able to eat 3 meals a day and being content with whatever you do to fill yourself.” This was the advice that Raju gave to the students in a place where they compete with high stakes, burnout and overexertion to secure the highest package from any educational institution. He mentioned how he felt like youngsters had no choice but to always strive for more and not be able to enjoy their time as children. He shares how anxious he feels when his son is out working because of how bad road rage has gotten. Since he only has one son, he is always worried about his son, and he is always praying.

The reason he wants to stick to selling utilities is because it is less stressful for him. He mentioned how hard it was with his other ventures because he was constantly worried about things going out of trend, but here, where he sells utilities, he isn't as worried because these utilities are basic needs, and basic needs never go out of trend. He said he enjoys selling it too because he gets to hear the concerns of parents whose children are navigating the city, and he likes giving them advice on how to stay safe in the city. While the faint smell of cigarettes and agarbatti clouded his shop, it somehow made one comfortable to buy things from him. His shop wasn't the prettiest of them all, nor did he sell the most aesthetically pleasing, but it certainly stands out from the other shops because of how friendly the owner is. One might argue that it is a tactic to sell more products, but it seems the owner is just trying to make his community. A loyal customer happened to be present during the interview and said, “I think our relationship is now more than just a buyer and seller; we've kind of become others' family now. He doesn't only sell quality goods but also quality time,” said Mr Sundeep in the cramped space of the shop while buying toilet brushes.

“4 years later, after these students graduate, they might not even remember the things they brought from my shop, but they'll have created memories of the things they brought from here.”

This dimly lit shop might not be as prevalent in our memories, but in a small corner of a cramped locality, there lies a shop trying to serve independence to those living alone for the first time.

Raju-[REDACTED]

Sundeep-[REDACTED]



Reflective essay

This assignment made me understand the lives of people like Raju who are the real backbone of our society. Raju's story reflects the reality of countless migrants who leave their hometowns in search of stability. It was interesting to know how Raju had to struggle with the language barrier but still decided to settle here in Bangalore. Raju's life highlights the resilience required to survive in a fast-paced urban environment. Over the years, he experimented with several businesses before finding stability in his utilities shop which caters to the daily needs of the local community. Despite rising costs, traffic congestion, and the challenges of running a business, he continues to contribute to the functioning of the neighbourhood. People like Raju are the backbone of our country. Their labour, determination, and sacrifices keep cities running smoothly. This assignment made me realise that India's growth is built not only on large institutions but on ordinary individuals whose stories often go unnoticed.



Serving home on a Tawa: The story of Amritsari Kulche

By: Swastika and Eeshika Banerjee

“Achha lagta hai sabko khana khilana” (‘It feels nice to feed other people’), the chef says with a humble smile, as he prepares to re-heat the tawa and flip the kulches for the day. Amritsari Kulcha Hut- a popular spot tucked away inside the corners of SG Palya’s bustling streets, filled with students and professionals alike. Christ University attracts a large crowd from every nook and cranny of India, and the north Indian population in the lively streets of this locality is indispensable. Hence it is quite natural for these students to be craving a taste of home in Bengaluru a city still largely dominated by the Kannada population who seem quite satisfied with their idli-sambar, vadas, and dosas. But many from different parts of India struggle to adapt to the taste of sour, spicy, tangy cuisine and pine for buttery, oily, fried and basically authentic north Indian food.

And that is precisely what Kartik Jain, owner of the popular kulchespot connected with. Hailing from Ludhiana, Punjab he has been in the city for 2 and a half years which is long enough to understand and empathize with the students’ plight i.e. lack of authentic north Indian food. Punjab, a state infamous for its food, culture and vibrancy undoubtedly has a special place in every Indian’s heart, no matter whether they’re from the north or south. Kartik can affirm, as he has numerous regular south Indian customers too.

Having born and grown into a business family owning a clothing manufacturing line, he knew from a young age that he needed to go into business. The restaurant emerged one fine day, when his “mamu” (uncle) asked him to be business partners, and Amritsari Kulchescame into being. The idea was simple- give the students a taste of home at extremely affordable rates and build trust with exceptional quality of the food which is being served to them. Therefore, its no wonder that every youngster in and around SG Palya would consider Amritsari Kulche to be a fan favourite.

“Of course, I am proud to sell Punjabi food”, Kartik says with a smile, being a firm believer of food having the power to connect people from far and wide. He leads his business with a strong army of three trained chefs, all of whom were trained in the art of Punjabi cooking, right from the hearths of Ludhiana itself. Being of the belief that food carries a universal spirit that can make one feel at home no matter which state of country they’re in, Kartik truly loves his desi Punjabi food. Dishes such as pani-puri take him right back to his childhood, in his hometown where his mother would make dal makhani ever so often. He says that the taste still lingers in his mouth even after all these years, and nothing could ever match the emotion attached to one’s mother’s cooking prepared with her own hands. Although in an attempt to

bridge the gap between home cooked food and the taste of one's roots, this business was originated in the first place.

Kartik knows how to cook but he doesn't do so often and his daily meals include a lot of kulche, bhature, aloo puri and of course lassi. "I try to makeup for it at the gym", he says with a laugh. He is a strong advocate for authenticity of Indian food and wants to keep his business and menu as true to his roots, as possible. He is not interested in venturing into fusion food or mixing of cuisines. The only expansion he is interested in, is to include more Punjabi dishes such 'makki ke roti' and 'sarso saag', which he feels are the truest representations of Punjabi culture yet keep kulches as the highlight. A few months ago, he started a supply chain of frozen kulches to Canada. However their shelf life was restricted to just a week due to the lack of artificial preservatives, which went right against his core principles of maintaining authenticity. Govind Kumar, one of the lead chefs coming from Bihar is an integral part of the restaurant. He has been working for Kartik and his family for about 15 years now, and wishes to continue to do the same in the near future. Govind, a migrant from the state of Bihar, was welcomed with smiles when he first came to Ludhiana. Kartik's family helped Govind in learning the art of making kulchas, because of which Govind was able to support his family. When asked if he had ever thought of starting his own business, Govind's shy smile seemed to say a lot, but he stated that the thought of starting own business had never crossed his mind, he feels content in working for Kartik and his family. Govind misses his family but says that he has to stay away from them in order to work and earn a living for everyone in the family. When questioned about anything else Govind has wished to do, he stated that through his art of making kulchas, serving people has been something that makes him feel very happy and satisfied. Kartik and team of three chefs will continue to serve Bangalore with the best Punjabi kulchas. The passion pride and taste of authentic Punjabi kulche are what make people return to their restaurant and relive the feeling of being at home.

Reflective essay

Being a Haryanvi myself, I have always craved good North Indian food in college. I discovered Kartik's Amritsari Kulche on a random Tuesday, when my friends and I were out trying to find a good food spot. With the first bite, I truly felt at home, as the food reminded me of my mother's cooking. This food spot holds a very special place in my heart, as it is the closest I have ever felt to home in Bangalore. Kartik's passion for his culture and food was truly inspiring. His insistence on keeping the food authentic in his restaurant shows that his main goal with his business is to spread his culture in the most original way possible. Talking to the head chef, Govind, made us understand that migrant workers like him feel content in working for people like Kartik. The wholesome smile on Govind's face when we asked if he enjoys doing his job, reflected the genuine passion and happiness that he finds in serving people through his cooking. However, I found it intriguing as to why Govind never thought of starting his own business despite learning the art of making kulchas. Overall, this whole

assignment taught me one small thing: in a small corner of SG Palaya, Kartik and his team of three chefs serve the best kulchas in town with passion and pride for their Punjabi culture. The love they have for their food is clearly visible in the smiles of the people leaving the restaurant.

Source log- Kartik jain(owner)- [REDACTED]





From Red Ferraris to Frame Rates: The Cinematic Drive of Aryan
By: Swastika and Vedanth Nair

The room is dim, lit only by the soft, clinical glow of a high-end editing suite. For Aryan, this is where the magic happens. Aryan's world is defined by his gear and the technical pursuit of the perfect shot. Currently, his focus is singular: upgrading his equipment and refining his filming techniques to move beyond just "car videos" and into the realm of high-end automotive cinema. "When I was 3 or 4, I went to this luxury resort where I saw a bright red Ferrari, that was where my love for automobiles began," says Aryan, an 18 year-old reel creator, cinematographer and photographer who has a deep passion for cars and automobiles. His niche mostly includes car, car-conventions and cinematic videos that he shoots and edits himself. What started as a toddler's fascination was fueled by his father's own interest in cars and Sunday mornings spent watching the high-stakes world of Formula 1. "I had a lot of free time, and that is when I went to my first car convention, where I got to meet people from this field and learn more about automobiles," says Aryan as he talks about his journey as a content creator. Ironically, Aryan's greatest digital success didn't come from his most technical work. A simple, minimalist reel of a Land Rover Defender inspired by a friend's clean approach to filming a Porsche unexpectedly exploded, racking up over a million views and 100,000 likes. Even though he really liked the simple idea, Aryan did not expect the video to blow up like that as it was a "low effort" reel compared to his previous work, he said "It irritated me a lot as I spent days editing one reel." Aryan thinks that figuring out the Instagram algorithm is the most painful part about being a content creator which surprisingly he does not do. He strongly believes in putting out content that he is passionate about, for Aryan a reel is a success as long as it earns the respect of his peers and loved ones. Automobile and car edits in itself is a very popular niche on social media platforms. As he was asked about his path to becoming the ultimate gatekeeper of automotive knowledge for his circle, Aryan stated that he is focusing on equipment and the way his reels are being shot. He draws heavy inspiration from Raveen Arora, a creator who revolutionized the niche by changing how cars are presented on screen. As Aryan talks about his shift from cars to cinematography, he mentioned how his travel reel to Mumbai did not do that well, but it did not bother him as he wanted to showcase his passions other than cars, expanding his niche. When asked what success would mean to him as a content creator he said, "To be monetized and to actually push my content, I should be able to make money out of my content."

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Swastika-2530168

Vedanth Nair- 2530175

Viewer: Mansha- XXXXXXXXXX

Final tabloid submission

The Street Sentry

Filter Coffee, Fresh
Flowers, and a Canon
Event

By- Swastika

Church street on a Saturday afternoon is all about college students with their filter coffee breath, tripping over stacks of used paper cups on the pavements and inhaling a mix of fresh flowers and expensive cologne. It's busy, it's frantic but so full of life. I was trying to navigate my way through Blossom's when the sea of people suddenly parted. Coming towards me was a guy with the kind of smile meant to be in a toothpaste advertisement, and a small microphone in his hand. "Hi! You guys look really fun" he said, and my friend and I gave each other that knowing look. This is that one canon event that takes place in every person's life who has ever visited Church street, getting interviewed by content creators. As me and my friend agreed to give that interview, we prepared ourselves for a possible roast on the internet. As I got asked the most controversial questions about dating and men, I made sure to look into the life of a content creator outside of weekends and shoot days. And that is exactly what I found out about Vidyuth and his team when they are not geared up with microphones and heavy cameras. As he unraveled his life in front of us, we got to know that outside of being a social butterfly, asking people for interviews on Church street, Vidyuth is a neurospace scientist on the week days. The most complex part about Vidyuth's job as a creator is to decide within the first three seconds of seeing a person whether they would look good in front of the camera and his content. "I read aura," is what Vidyuth had to say when we asked him about his decision making skills. He explained how seeing me and my friend with charming smiles and a welcoming aura helped him decide quickly. Even if someone is born with the social skills of a social God, the biggest challenge about asking people for an interview is to learn the art of rejection. When asked how he deals with the rejection that comes with this profession, Vidyuth confessed how he does not give a "damn" about getting rejected. In this age of extreme Performatism where interviews become a good way of portraying a false portrait of one's self, getting authentic or true answers becomes quite the task. Vidyuth highly agreed as he stated, "They show the side they want people to see." He also states that this act of being performative for a camera is something that happens subconsciously to everyone. In the midst of our conversation we also found out how Vidyuth is quite new to this profession of interviewing people in Bangalore. He also talked about how he does not have a specific hook to stop people, instead he tries to read their aura and

comes up with more personalized versions of asking for an interview. When we hear the word 'Neuro-scientist' we automatically understand how complex of a career it must be, for Vidyuth doing content creation on the weekends is his day-off or "break". He says how this becomes a good way to socialize as during the normal working days he is glued to his monitor, probably working on understanding microgravity. Oxytosinofficail, Vidyuth's page is not the only page dedicated to taking such a niche, when asked how he feels about other people pursuing the same niche as him, he stated that he does not see any point in competing with others. As the shining ball in the sky set behind the buildings, the crowd changed and the world seemed to slow down, I bid goodbye to Vidyuth and his team hoping to not see myself on their page. The warm yellow lights of the church street lit up our faces as we moved towards the main road in search for a high price-auto, and with a hope of visiting this lively place again.

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